

History of Contemporary Worlds: XX & XXI Centuries

Wk2 WWI in Europe & Asia

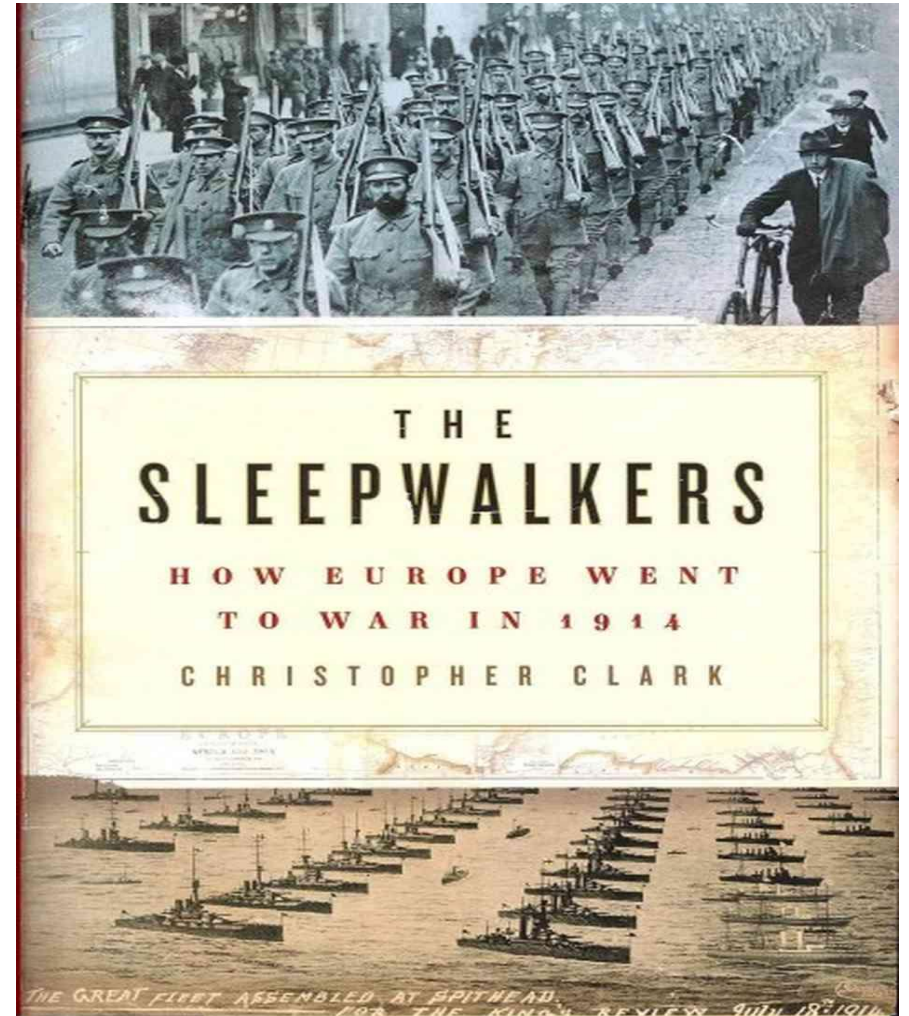
- **The Great War, Total War, World War**
 - Mobilization
 - Destruction
 - Global scale
- **Aftermath**
 - Versailles
 - War of a deeper kind: nature
 - Global flu
 - Global relief
 - Asian developments



Soldiers near Ypres, Belgium, October 1917.

A series of miscalculations?

“The key decision-makers...walked towards danger in watchful, calculated steps... Nationalism, armaments, alliances and finance were all part of the story, but they can be made to [each] carry real explanatory weight only if they can be seen to have shaped the decisions that – in combination – made war break out.”



WWI: the **decisive** 20th century event?

- **Scale** of War.
 - 70 million soldiers mobilized
 - 10 million people killed
- **Nature** of War – Total War
 - First large-scale **application of industry to conflict**
 - **Mobilization** of all parts of society in unprecedented ways
 - Attempted elimination of an entire people: 1.5 million Armenians
- **Legacy** of War
 - “World War I is the foundational disaster of the twentieth century... Without World War I, there would be no Hitler, no Lenin, no Auschwitz. Most of the main features of the deeply divided twentieth century can be traced directly back to the first World War.” Jay Winter (historian)
 - **And Asia?** No May Fourth?

WWI: why the “Great War”?

- The forces behind **total war**: mobilisation of **citizen-soldiers**; of **workers** (women); of **carers** (nurses, mothers); of the **colonized** (Africans and Indians); of global **laborers** (Chinese); of **deportees** or **refugees** or **internees** (camps); of **science** (for both harm and healing); of **technology** (tanks, planes, but crucially subs); of **economies** (+ strangling them); of **media** (censorship); of **passions** (propaganda); of **relief** (to Belgium, Austria & Near East)

Total war

- Mass mobilisation
 - Creation of **national citizen-armies**: public education, conscription & propaganda.
- Blurring of the lines between homefront and battlefield
 - Mobilisation of the homefront: women into factories; wives support troops; boy scouts
 - Civilians targeted, not just collateral (bombing; blockades; torpedoes: *Lusitania* in 1915)
- Arms races: global competition + technology + new ways of organisation
 - Naval (Britain vs Germany):
Germany launches long-term naval building program in 1898 to challenge Britain's dominance.
 - Land (France vs Germany):
1913: German Army Law: **increase in peacetime army numbers**.
1913: France **extends compulsory military service** from 2 to 3 years.
- This all adds up to the creation of all-encompassing '**wartime economies**'
 - State control over key industries—railways, munitions, mines, etc.
 - Price controls, war bonds, food rations

Propaganda – dehumanisation + mass media:
cultivated animosity towards combatants + civilians
(plus personal investment in the war effort)



Russian war bonds
« to hasten
victory »



Source gallica.bnf.fr / Bibliothèque nationale de France



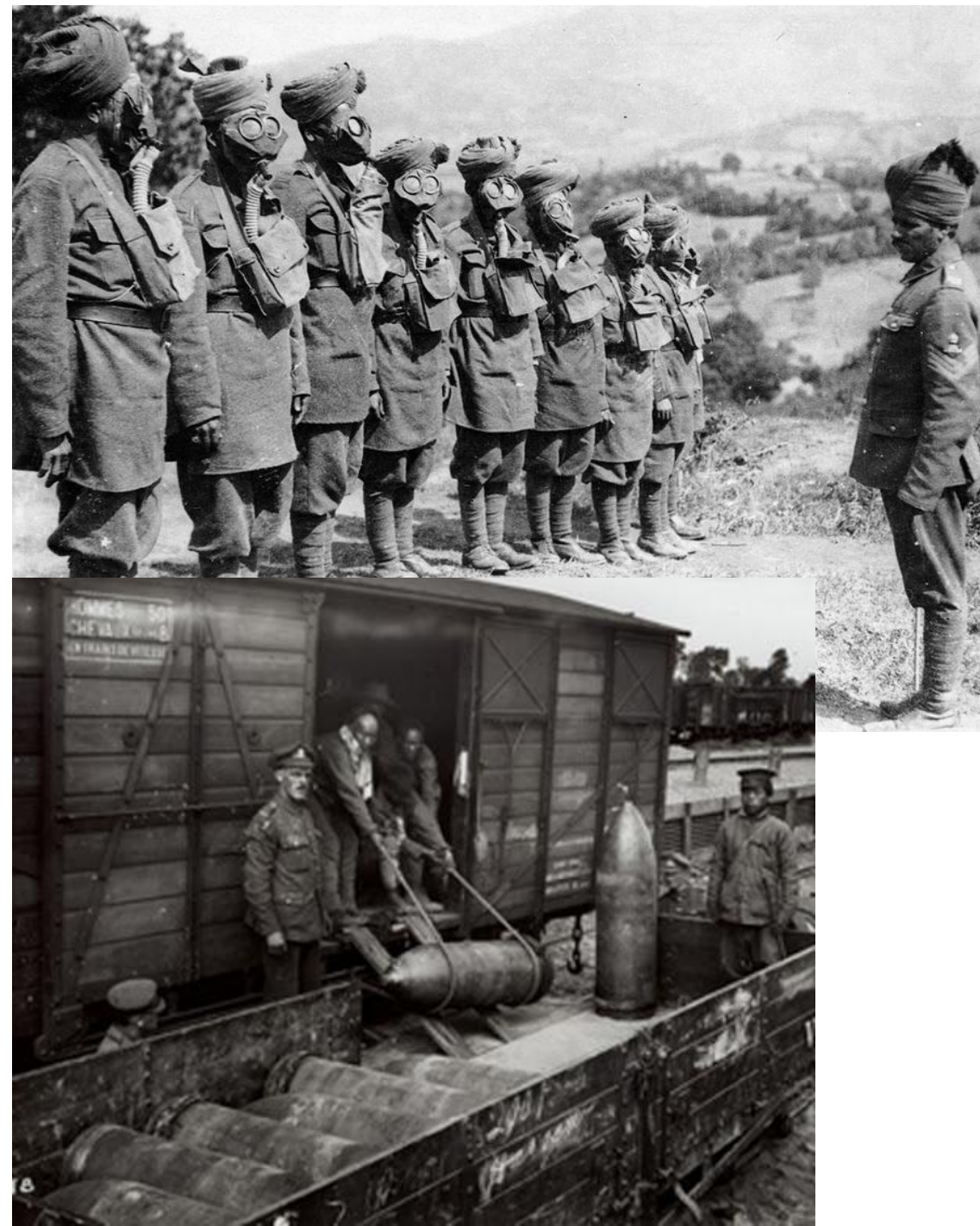
The (UK) homefront mobilises: women and war

- **Emmeline Pankhurst** (1908,)
- Changes to the type of work performed by women and its more public nature
- Shift from domestic service to wartime industries (with higher wages)
 - In UK, by August 1916, 334,000 women working in munitions factories
- Advance: March 1918 most UK women aged 30 or older given the vote
- Retrenchment: by 1921, percentage of women in workforce the same as 1910
- [UK shell production: factory to frontlines](#)



World War

- 1.4 million Indian soldiers (over 74,000 killed)
- 1.3 million from 'white dominions': Canada etc
- April 25, 1915: Allies (**Anzac**) land at Gallipoli
- From France's colonies:
 - 600,000 soldiers & 200,000 workers
- 200,000 Chinese recruited by French & British to dig trenches, bury dead, repair tanks etc
- United States enters war in April 1917
- **Intensely transnational war** in various ways
- Oct 1915: small East Asian/Pacific theater opens in Qingdao, China, with major repercussions...



After four years of trench warfare, the final phase of war: 1918

- Verdun: 300+ day battle in 1916: +700,000 casualties
- Fleeting German optimism at the end of 1917
 - Russia defeated in the East
 - British and French offensives dulled
- Spring (or 'Ludendorff') offensive, March/April 1918.
 - Spectacular advances...but not strategically significant.
- Turning point – July/August 1918
 - Rolling British/French counteroffensive
 - Did not break German lines, just German resolve
 - Surrender: **November 11, 1918.**
 - A surrender without Allied troops ever setting foot on German soil.



11 Nov 1918 armistice; 28 June 1919 treaty



Country	Total Mobilized Forces	Killed	Wounded	Prisoners and Missing	Total Casualties	Casualties as % of Forces
ALLIED AND ASSOCIATED POWERS						
Russia	12,000,000	1,700,000	4,950,000	2,500,000	9,150,000	76.3
British Empire	8,904,467	908,371	2,090,212	191,652	3,190,235	35.8
France	8,410,000	1,357,800	4,266,000	537,000	6,160,800	73.3
Italy	5,615,000	650,000	947,000	600,000	2,197,000	39.1
United States	4,355,000	116,516	204,002	4,500	323,018	7.1
Japan	800,000	300	907	3	1,210	0.2
Romania	750,000	335,706	120,000	80,000	535,706	71.4
Serbia	707,343	45,000	133,148	152,958	331,106	46.8
Belgium	267,000	13,716	44,686	34,659	93,061	34.9
Greece	230,000	5,000	21,000	1,000	27,000	11.7
Portugal	100,000	7,222	13,751	12,318	33,291	33.3
Montenegro	50,000	3,000	10,000	7,000	20,000	40.0
TOTAL	42,188,810	5,142,631	12,800,706	4,121,090	22,062,427	52.3
ALLIED AND ASSOCIATED POWERS						
Germany	11,000,000	1,773,700	4,216,058	1,152,800	7,142,558	64.9
Austria-Hungary	7,800,000	1,200,000	3,620,000	2,200,000	7,020,000	90.0
Turkey	2,850,000	325,000	400,000	250,000	975,000	34.2
Bulgaria	1,200,000	87,500	152,390	27,029	266,919	22.2
TOTAL	22,850,000	3,386,200	8,388,448	3,629,829	15,404,477	67.4
GRAND TOTAL	65,038,810	8,528,831	21,189,154	7,750,919	37,466,904	57.5

http://www.uwosh.edu/faculty_staff/henson/188/WWI_Casualties%20and%20Deaths%20%20PBS.html

Verdun today



Victors' competing visions - The Big Three

- Paris Peace Conference
 - Opens 18 January 1919 with delegates from 27 nations.
 - For 6 months, a world government in Paris.
 - **Treaty of Versailles** on **28 June 1919**. Officially ends WWI.
- French goals (wins out as Wilson is flu-ridden):
 - Permanently weakened “responsible/aggressive” Germany.
 - Compensation for damage – northern France devastated.
 - 25% of French men aged 18-30 killed / wounded.
- British goals:
 - Stability in Europe & safeguarding their global empire.
- American goals (Wilson’s but not US Senate’s):
 - Doctrine of **self-determination** amid crumbling multi-ethnic (landed) empires
 - **Internationalism**: League of Nations forms in 1920



David Lloyd George (UK), Georges Clemenceau (Fr.), Woodrow Wilson (US).

Legacy: Who was at fault?

- Article 231 of the Treaty of Versailles – the “War Guilt Clause”

The Allied and Associated Governments affirm and Germany accepts the responsibility of Germany and her allies for causing all the loss and damage to which the Allies and Associated Governments and their nationals have been subjected as a consequence of the war imposed upon them by the aggression of Germany and her allies.



A 'peace to end all wars' (Wilson)? ... or a foundation for WWII?

- One view: Germans are victimised:
- Germany is made to pay reparations of 20 billion gold marks over 1920-32 (\$4.5 billion dollars).
- Germany lost 13.5% of its territory.
- Sudeten Germans put into Czechoslovakia
- Was Germany the only one to blame for how the war unfolded?
- Counter-argument (among historians):
- In fact lenient treatment of Germany
 - 1920-32: reparations only 8% of German gross national income.
 - Germany produced 30% more iron and 38% more steel in 1927 than it had in 1913.
 - Germany still a great power in central Europe.
- Myth of the “war guilt” clause – Article 231 of Treaty.
 - Only establishes German liability for damage to civilian property – no use of term “guilt”.



Regardless, the war and its consequences will figure in political developments in Germany's Weimar republic and around the world into the 1930s.

War on deeper levels

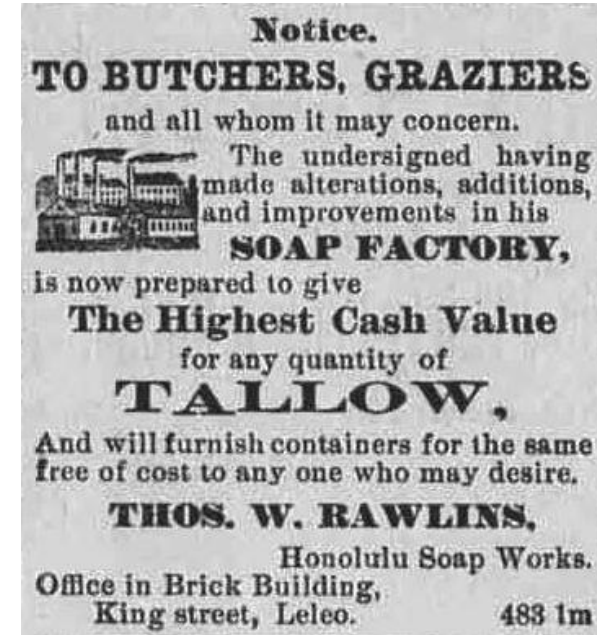
‘The First World War is the decisive event in the history of the twentieth century. It determined its entire character. It was this war that demonstrated that the *transformation of the world into a laboratory for releasing reserves of energy accumulated over billions of years* can be achieved only by means of wars.’

“Wars of the Twentieth Century and the Twentieth Century as War”
(1975), Czech philosopher Jan Patocka

(quoted in Becker’s ‘The Great War’)

« I can recall the smell of our cowyard [in Gippsland, Victoria, Australia] with ease, and the sheepyards and hay and silage, soil and superphosphate, though it is forty years since I smelt them. But the masses of animals sent for boiling down, in **works that dotted the pastoral landscape like a kind of animal gulag**, made a stench of a different order. The idea appears to have come from Russia. There was little science to it: the men took their heavy hammers into a yard, knocked the animals in the head, bled them into a trough and threw the carcasses into the boiling vat, from which the fat was run off into barrels. Each man could do about 130 sheep a day. Cattle, being a little harder to brain and whose bodies needed hacking into pieces, took a good deal longer. Years later, to the satisfaction of those who thought the original method wasteful, a new process turned the beasts into ‘extract of beef’ (or mutton – or horse, presumably), as well as **tallow** [...] Towards the end of the [19th] century the Rockhampton [Queensland] works was turning 100 000 animals into tallow a year [...]. Much that happened in the bush after the Europeans came, including the smell of it, can be traced to an **‘indissoluble and particularly pleasing union’ between the imperial banks and Australian squatters** that emerged in the 1830s... »

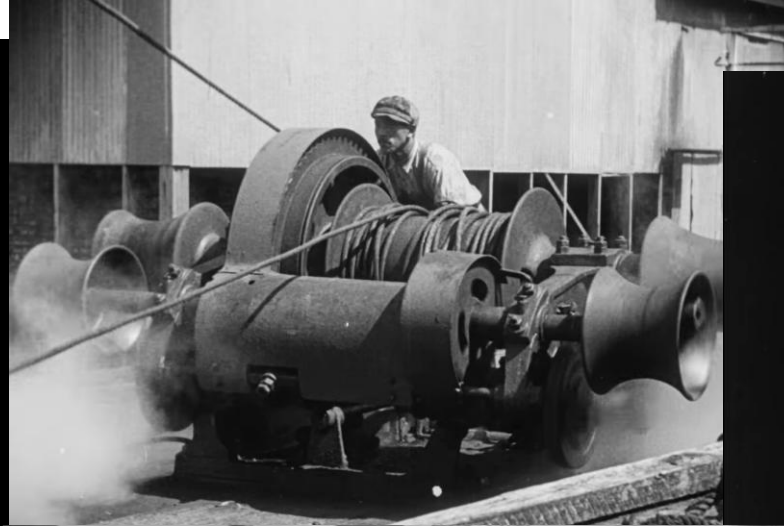
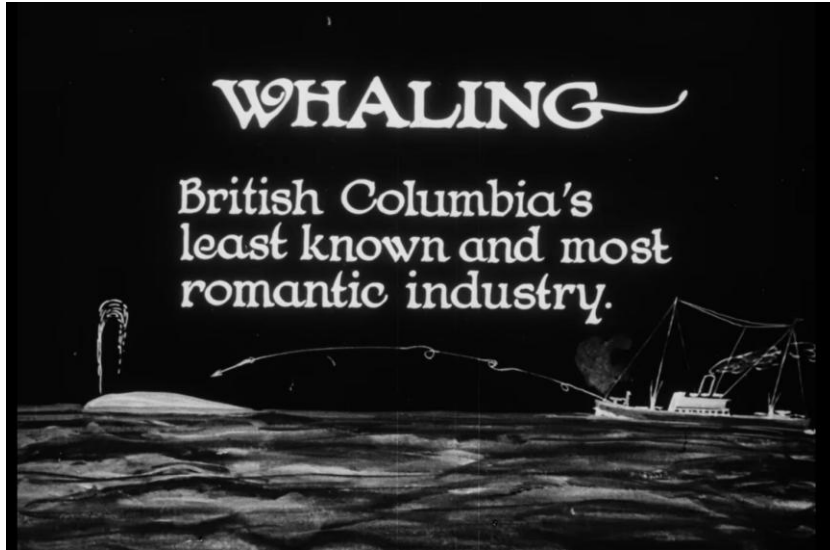
Don Watson, *The Bush*. Penguin, 2014.



Daily Bulletin,
Honolulu, Hawai'i, 1883

War of another kind: on nature

-seen through a Canadian documentary from 1919



Seventy tons of whale
are turned over with
the greatest ease.



An old time whaler who
views with awe the modern
processes of handling
these monsters of the deep.



Suggested Radiolab podcast (on Moodle) on WWI and 1918 Influenza



Lining up for flu
masks in San
Francisco, 1918

Mobilisation of goodwill

November 16, 1914 THE INDEPENDENT 263

THE FACE OF THE EARTH

The latest geodetic surveys disclose the fact that the average elevation of the United States above sea-level is about 2500 feet.

Natural gas has been found along the base of the Rocky Mountains in northern Alberta, and preparations for its extensive use are making at Edmonton and elsewhere.

Swiss meteorologists announce that altho the mighty Rhone glacier is still dwindling, most of the Swiss glaciers have advanced decidedly lately, owing to the unusual cold summers of the last two years.

The planting of vanilla, for which the Seychelle Islands were long famous, has been somewhat neglected of late in favor of coconut growing; but planters are now resuming the culture of the vanilla beans on an extensive scale and under improved methods.

The United States Geological Survey has lately issued a large book on the Missouri River drainage-area, in which it is shown that the Missouri rises in Redrock Lake, in the Rocky Mountains, 6700 feet above sea-level, flows thru ten states, and has a total drainage-area of 492,000 square miles.

European oceanographers are urging that advantage be taken of the approaching naval celebration of the opening of the Panama Canal to make a simultaneous transatlantic survey of the ocean, every one of the vessels converging toward Panama carrying out similar and nearly coincident scientific work as they cross the Atlantic.

Astronomers report that the dust from the explosion of the Katmai volcano, in the Aleutian Islands, in August, 1912, has now nearly settled. The clearing of the atmosphere has taken less time than after the Katmai eruption of 1902-3, and much less than following the outburst of Krakatoa in 1883, when some obscurity remained in the atmosphere for three years.

The greatness of the Pamirs, the high mountain region between Kashmir

SOS

Belgians Are Starving

"He Gives Twice Who Gives Quickly"

MILLIONS of Belgians face starvation. They will perish if succor does not come at once. Their plight is desperate. It cries out as imperiously as the wireless S. O. S. from a sinking ship. And this call is being heeded. Fast ships bearing food have been rushed to the rescue. But more must follow.

Cable Answers S. O. S.

This Belgian Relief Committee cabled \$50,000 from big, generous America to Ambassador Page, to use for buying food in England to hurry to Belgium as first aid, and \$20,000 was cabled to United States Minister Brand Whitlock, in Brussels, and used in the same way. In Brussels alone one hundred soup kitchens are feeding 100,000 hungry people. The daily cable dispatches, in unbiased news reports, are giving a continuous account of the appalling disaster and desolation.

Succor From America

In America how different the picture. This magazine will reach its readers just about Thanksgiving time. We have had bountiful harvests and despite rather dull times we have great surpluses of food and money. So 40 national magazines are carrying in their Christmas issues this appeal to their millions of readers to succor the starving Belgians. Divide your Christmas plenty with them. Be sure that the gift will be "twice blessed."

Send a Christmas Check Today

Send a check today, before it slips your mind, to J. P. Morgan & Co., 23 Wall Street, New York, and mark it for the Belgian Relief Fund. You will receive a receipt and the money will at once go to the Belgian Relief Committee, which will use it for these two purposes:

- 1 To relieve immediate distress of Belgian refugees and the hundreds of thousands of destitute women and children and other non-combatants in Belgium.
- 2 To rehabilitate as soon as practicable the poor Belgian peasant and working classes by helping them get roofs over their heads and tools to work with.

BELGIAN RELIEF COMMITTEE
10 Bridge Street, New York

REV. J. F. STILLEMANS, President.
ROBERT W. DEFOREST, Chairman of Executive Committee.
EMANUEL HAVENITH, Belgian Minister to the United States.
PIERRE MAIL, Consul-General at New York.

LYMAN ARBOTT	HENRY W. DEFOREST	W. BARCLAY PARSONS
OTTO T. BARNARD	CLEVELAND H. DOIG	BERNARD RAAP
ARMAND BATT	LIONEL HAGENAERS	JOHN VAN RICKSTAL
JAMES N. BELL	THOMAS N. HUBBARD	FRANCIS LYNDE STETSON
GORELIP N. BLISS	RAY A. O. NYS	THOMAS TEASDALE
ROBERT S. BREWSTER	HENRY FAIRFIELD OSBORN	FRANK A. VANDERLIP
		ALFRED T. WHITE

S. O. S.—Checks, Money Orders, etc., should be made to J. P. MORGAN & CO.
"FOR BELGIAN RELIEF FUND," 23 Wall Street, and sent to that address



- 1914-20s – huge refugee/famine crises in Europe/Russia/Near East
- Blockade of Europe – food shortages in Belgium & Germany; Commission for the Relief of Belgium, 1914-18 (Herbert Hoover, later heads American Relief Administration)
- In 1919 alone US Congress raises \$200 million and US public donates another \$200 million for ARA operations
- Save the Children founded in UK, 1919

Meanwhile in Asia

- Oct 1914: Japan aid UK in Qingdao
- Jan 1915: **Tokyo's « 21 demands »** on Beijing; kicks off mass boycotts
- Feb 1915: **Singapore mutiny**
- 1915: China's **New Culture Movement**
- Chinese 200,000 labor corps to France
- 1919: Versailles hands Qingdao to Japan
- **May Fourth Movement** explodes



Cartoon: « Social Progress » 1920

Locomotive: « New Culture »

Old Woman « Accepting fate as it comes »

Old Man « Taking the Past as the Model »

Next week ...

- Set reading: **Eric D. Weitz**, “From the Vienna to the Paris System: International Politics and the Entangled Histories of Human Rights, Forced Deportations, and Civilizing Missions,” *The American Historical Review* 113/5 (Dec., 2008), 1313-1343.
-
- PRIMARY SOURCE: **Vladimir I. Lenin**, “The Transition from Capitalism to Communism” (1917).